



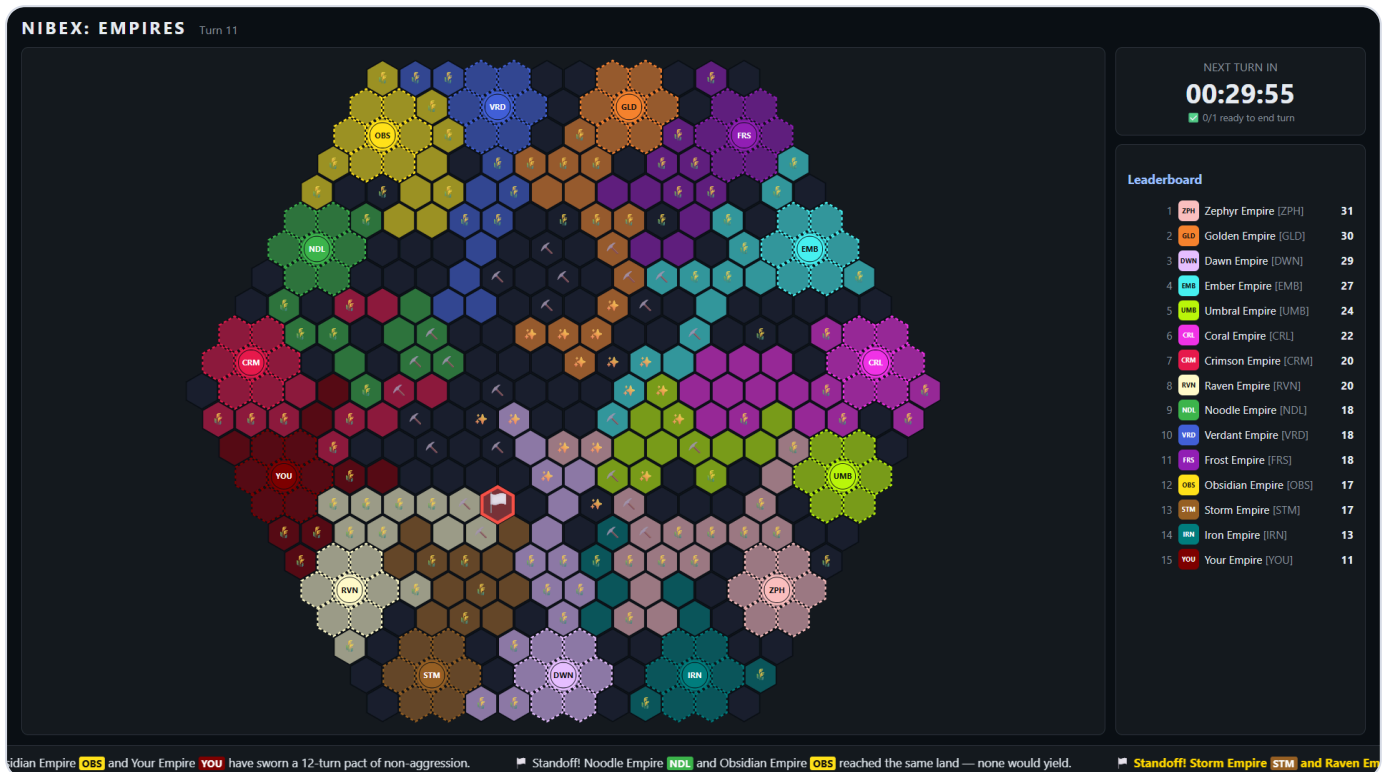
NIBEX: EMPIRES

The Official Field Manual — read this before you arrive

NIBEX 2026 · THE CUP AWAITS

Three laws govern the weekend:

1. **Anonymity is sacred.** You may keep your real identity secret all weekend. All player-to-player communication happens *inside the game* — no whispering alliances in the kitchen.
2. **No advantage for camping the app.** Everyone gets the same orders, and everything resolves at the same instant. Play in two minutes between movies.
3. **Deception is a feature.** Lie, betray, hoard, rob. The game will tell everyone what you did — sometimes.



The war room: the big TV shows the live map, leaderboard, and news ticker all weekend.

1 • What Is This?

Nibex: Empires is a slow-burn empire game played on your phone across the whole weekend. Everyone rules a small empire on a shared hex map shown on the TV. You expand, build armies, trade threats and promises, raid supply lines, rob vaults in the night, and complete secret quests — all in short visits to your phone between everything else Nibex has going on.

The world advances on a clock: every **turn** (default: 30 minutes), everyone's queued orders resolve *simultaneously*. Nobody sees your orders before they happen. At night the world sleeps; at **Daybreak** everything queued overnight resolves in one dramatic burst.

On Sunday afternoon the game locks and the **Final Tally** plays out on the TV — including points nobody could see, and the reveal of *who actually played each empire*. Highest total takes the cup.

 **The leaderboard can lie.** The TV shows public points only. Hidden relic points (from quests) are revealed only at the finale — last place on the screen might be the true champion.

2 · Getting Started

Join the game

1. Scan the QR code on the TV (or visit the join address on the house Wi-Fi).
2. Enter your **real name** (only the admin ever sees it — until the finale reveal!).
3. Invent an **empire name** and a 2–4 letter **abbreviation**. This is your public identity.
4. Pick a **4-digit PIN** — it lets you reconnect from another device, or after logging out.
5. Your **banner** is generated for you: your abbreviation on your empire's color, matching your territory on the map.

Join Nibex: Empires

Found a new empire

Your real name is only visible to the admin.

Your name (kept private if you stay anonymous)

Empire name

Abbreviation (2–4 letters)

Create a 4-digit PIN — lets you reconnect from another device

Your banner is generated automatically — your abbreviation on your empire's color.

Found my empire

Reconnect to your empire

Already founded an empire? Enter its abbreviation and your PIN.

Empire abbreviation

Your 4-digit PIN

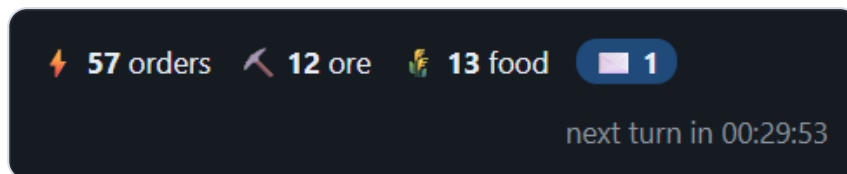
Reconnect

Founding an empire takes about 30 seconds.

👁️ **Joining is anonymous.** While the game is in the lobby, the TV only announces "a player has joined." Empire names, colors, and emblems all reveal together at launch — so nobody can match an empire to whoever just had their phone out.

3 · Your Screen

Everything you do happens at **/play** on your phone. Top to bottom:



Your resources, orders, countdown to the next turn — and the End Turn button.

- ⚡ **Orders** — your action budget. You gain **5 per turn** automatically; unspent orders carry through the day but **expire at Daybreak**. Spend them before bed!
- ⚒ **Ore** — builds armies (muster).
- 🍲 **Food** — moves armies and feeds skulduggery (attacks, spies, heists).
- ✅ **End turn** — when *every* player presses it, the turn resolves immediately instead of waiting for the clock. (Never during Nightfall.)
- 📌 **badge** — appears when you have unread messages. Tap it to jump to Diplomacy.

Map



Tap a tile to give an order.



Expand here



Muster ( each)

1



Attack (1 )

For your own glory



Spy (1 )



Move troops from here



Raid from here

Tap any tile for info and legal orders. Your garrisons show green badges; enemy border garrisons show red; spy intel shows purple.

4 · Reading the Map

- **Colored tiles** belong to empires — every empire is exactly one color, everywhere.
- **Dark tiles** are unclaimed. Icons show what a tile produces:  **ore**,  **food**,  **relic sites** — strange, valuable ground concentrated in the rich center (quests care about them).
- **Dashed outlines** are **wards** — each capital and its ring are protected forever.
- **Circled numbers** are garrisons: **green = yours**, **red = enemies on your border**, **purple = fresh spy intel** (one turn only).
- **Arrows** preview your queued orders: white = troop moves, red = tiles that will march when your attack fires.

Your ward — the lifeboat

Your capital and its surrounding ring can **never** be attacked, captured, spied into, or raided. You can never be fully eliminated. But warded land produces nothing and scores nothing — and every empire receives a flat **capital stipend of +1**  **and +1**  **every turn** no matter what. Surrounded? Muster an army *inside* the ward (nobody can see it), then march out and break the siege. A lifeboat with an army in it.

5 • The Orders

Expand

Cost: free · Target: unclaimed tile touching your territory

Claim land. If two empires grab the same tile the same turn, it's a **standoff** — nobody gets it, all orders wasted. You can also take unclaimed land **by force** with an Attack: troops march in and garrison it, and **soldiers beat settlers** — an armed claim wins over any bare expansion that turn.

Muster

Cost: 1  per strength (pick the quantity — one order total) · Target: any tile you own, wards included

Raise garrison strength. Garrisons defend their tile and march on attacks launched from beside it. Mustering is invisible to everyone — the garrison your enemy scouted is not necessarily the garrison they'll fight.

Move

Cost: free · From your tile to your tile — adjacent, or 2 away through your own territory

Shift *as many or as few* troops as you like. Valid destinations glow blue. Moves resolve **after** battles, so moved troops are never dragged into a march — use moves to stage reserves one tile behind the front, backfill an emptied border, or reinforce a tile you captured that same turn.

Attack

Cost: 1  per march · From your garrisoned tile to an adjacent enemy or unclaimed tile (never a ward)

Select **your** tile → **Attack from here** → tap a glowing target → choose **how many march**. Committed troops leave home for the whole turn; everyone you hold back stays on the walls. Queued marches are previewed with red arrows. Want a converging assault? Queue attacks from several tiles at the same target — the columns merge into one army (each column costs its own ration). Resolution: attacker total vs. defender garrison, each rolling fortune $\times 0.8$ –1.2. Defender wins ties. Winner takes the tile with the survivors (attacker – defender, minimum 1). **No double-booking:** strength promised to one march or move can't be promised to another — and only strength that *exists when you queue* can be committed, so fresh recruits never join a same-turn march.

 **In support of:** declare your attack in support of another empire and your force merges into *their* attack on that tile. If they never march, you fight alone (you might accidentally conquer). Support declarations are published after the battle — promise wisely.

Raid

Cost: free · From your garrisoned tile to an adjacent enemy tile with troops on it

Hit their supply line. **50/50 odds:** success plunders 2 resources straight from their treasury (whichever they're richer in); failure costs you 1 strength. Raids are overt — the victim always knows it was you.

Spy

Cost: 1  · Target: enemy tile within 3 of your territory (not wards)

The report marks garrisons on the target and its neighbors **on your map in purple — for one turn only**, so act on it. Spies are caught 1 time in 4, and a caught spy tells the victim exactly who sent it.

Heist

Cost: 1  · Target: an EMPIRE with unwarded land within 2 of yours · Resolves at Daybreak only

Send thieves at another empire's relic vault. Thieves work only at night. One crew per vault per night — two crews hitting the same vault all flee empty-handed. Caught (30%): the whole house hears about it. Success: one random relic changes vaults, and **nobody ever knows it was you**.

The Market

Instant — not an order, no waiting, no cost beyond the exchange itself

Trade any time: 5  → 1  or 1  → 5 . The rate is fixed and symmetric. Surrounded with a full granary and no army? Sell the harvest and muster the same turn — the wrong treasury never locks you out of a war.

 **Changed your mind?** Every queued order can be cancelled before the turn resolves — costs are fully refunded. Tap an order in your queue to flash it on the map first, so you cancel the right one.

Your news

Tap a report to flash where it happened.

T11  Obsidian Empire **OBS** accepted your pact of non-aggression (through turn 23).

T1  New quest: Seize an enemy-held tile in battle.

 Your news: everything that happened TO you — tap a report to flash where it happened.

6 · Intel & Fog of War

- You always see **your own garrisons**.
- You see enemy garrisons only on unwarded tiles **touching your territory** — border intel. A red "0" means *undefended*.
- Deeper enemy land is fog. That's what spies are for.
- **Nobody can ever see inside a ward** — a warded army is an unknowable breakout threat.
- What no one ever sees: **orders queued for the next turn**. You see a border garrison *today* — not what's mustering into it right now.

7 · Diplomacy — and Betrayal



Private messages, pacts, and the full list of your treaties.

Messages

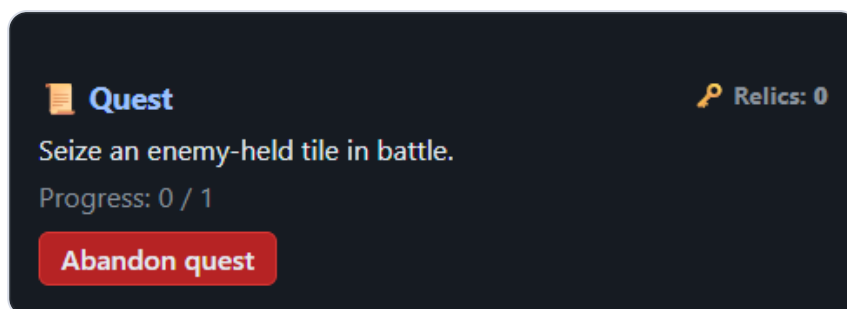
Message any empire privately — deals, threats, lies, misdirection, all fair game, and it's the **only** legal channel (law #1). Unread messages badge your screen.

Pacts of non-aggression

- Propose a pact **with a duration** (in turns). They accept or decline.
- Acceptance is **public** — the ticker announces it to the whole house.
- Pacts **expire on schedule**, publicly and peacefully. You may also **withdraw** early — public, honorable, no penalty.
- Pacts are **not enforced**. Attacking your partner is legal...

⚡ **OATHBREAKER.** Resolve an attack or raid against a pact partner — or get your thief caught in their vault — and the pact shatters with a thunderclap on the TV. For the next **6 turns** fortune abandons you: your attack luck rolls lose their entire upside (capped at ×1.0). Betrayal is legal. It's just expensive — and everyone will know.

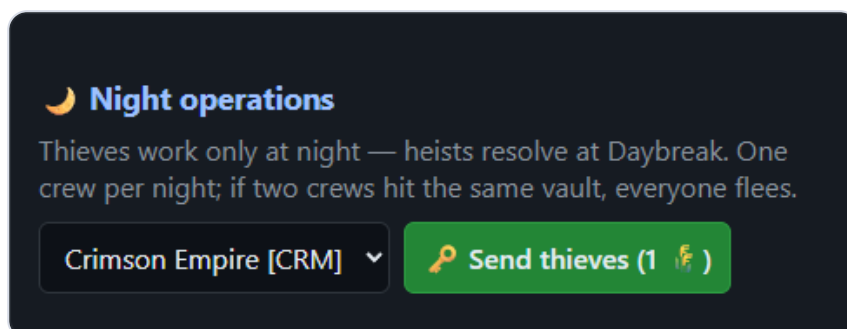
8 · Quests & Relics — the Hidden Score



Your current quest, its progress, and your relic count.

The game deals you quests (a few per day): hold a ✨ relic site, grow your empire, field an army, seize a tile in battle, camp on a named rival's border. Completing one banks a 🔑 **relic** in your vault.

- Each relic is worth **2–6 points** — **and nobody knows the value, not even you.**
- Relics **never** appear on the public leaderboard. They are added at the finale, one empire at a time, in front of everyone.
- Quest completions appear on the ticker *anonymously*: " ✨ Somewhere, a relic found a new keeper..."
- You can abandon a quest you hate, but it counts against the day's deals.
- Relics can be **stolen** (see Heist). A fat vault is a quiet temptation to every neighbor.



🌙 Night operations: pick a victim before bed, find out at breakfast.

9 • Scoring

Source	Points	Visible?
Each tile you hold outside your ward	1	✓ live on the TV
Each of those tiles in the rich center zone	+1 extra	✓ live on the TV
Stockpiled ore	+1 per 5 ⚔	✓ live on the TV
Stockpiled food	+1 per 10 🍲	✓ live on the TV
Total garrison strength (armies)	+1 per 5 🏹	✓ live on the TV
Each relic in your vault	+2 to +6 (secret)	🚫 finale only

Warded tiles score nothing — the lifeboat can't win the game. Territory, treasury, armies, and secrets can. Note that mustering never costs you points (5 ⚔ and 5 🏹 are worth the same) — but armies can die in battle, and stockpiles can't.

10 · The Clock: Turns, Nightfall, Daybreak

- The world advances every **30 minutes** (the TV counts down). All orders queued by everyone resolve at the same instant.
- You gain **5 orders per turn**, automatically, whether you're playing or napping. They carry through the day and **expire at Daybreak**.
- 🌙 **Nightfall (≈2am–10am)**: no turns fire. You can still queue anything — the night is one giant turn.
- 🌅 **Daybreak**: the first turn of the morning resolves everything queued overnight at once — battles, betrayals, and every heist. The most dramatic moment of each day. Then fresh orders for the new day.
- ✅ **End turn**: if every player is ready, the turn fires early. Great for fast sessions when everyone's in the room.

11 · How a Turn Resolves — the Exact Sequence

Every turn processes in this fixed order. When two things seem to conflict, this list is the law:

- 1 Daybreak check**
— if a new day has begun: all unspent orders expire; heists become due this turn.
- 2 Order income**
— every empire gains +5 ⚡.
- 3 Pact expiry**
— treaties that reached their agreed end dissolve, publicly and peacefully.
- 4 Capital stipend**
— every empire receives +1 🏹 +1 🍷, no matter what.
- 5 Production**
— +1 per unwarded 🏹 / 🍷 tile you hold.
- 6 Expansions**
— settlers claim unclaimed land; rival claims on the same tile standoff (nobody gets it).
- 7 Musters**
— new strength appears, unseen. It defends its tile *this same turn* — but recruits can never join a march queued this turn.
- 8 ⚔ Battles**
— each attack marches exactly the troops committed to it, from its chosen tile. Coalitions and converging columns merge, fortune rolls ($\times 0.8$ – 1.2 , oathbreakers capped at $\times 1.0$), defenders win ties, survivors garrison the prize. Soldiers beat settlers on contested neutral ground. Pacts broken here brand the OATHBREAKER.
- 9 🏹 Raids**
— supply-line skirmishes resolve at 50/50. (If the target garrison already marched away or died, the raid finds nothing.)
- 10 🚚 Moves**
— troops reposition *after* the fighting: never conscripted into a march, able to backfill an emptied border or garrison a fresh conquest.
- 11 🕵 Spy reports**
— scouts report the post-battle truth; purple intel appears on your map for one turn. 1-in-4 spies get caught instead.
- 12 🌙 Heists**
— Daybreak turns only. One crew per vault; collisions flee; 30% caught loudly; success moves a relic in perfect silence.
- 13 📜 Quests check**
— completed quests bank their relics (anonymous ticker tease).
- 14 New quests dealt**
— empires without an active quest draw a new one (up to the daily limit).
- 15 End-turn flags reset**
— and the countdown to the next turn begins.

 **The two consequences everyone forgets:** (1) Mustering into a tile that's attacked this turn joins the defense *before* the battle — bluffing gold. (2) Troops you commit to a march are gone from their tile for the whole turn — commit everything and your walls stand empty; hold some back and they defend.

12 · The Finale

Sunday afternoon the realm locks — no more orders, no more turns. The TV reads " 🏰 **AWAITING FINAL TALLY.**" When the whole house is gathered, the ceremony begins:

1. Starting from **last place**, each empire's score builds on screen: territory... stockpiles... then **the hidden relic points, revealed at last...** the total...
2. ...the empire's banner... and then the moment the whole weekend has been building to: **"...but WHO played it?"** — and the player's real name, in gold.
3. One by one, up the standings, until the **Champion of Nibex** is crowned in confetti.

Then somebody's name goes on the cup. 🏆

13 · Quick Reference

Order	Cost	Target	Resolves	Who finds out
 Expand	free	Unclaimed tile touching you	Step 6	Everyone (ticker)
 Muster ×N	N 	Your tile (wards OK)	Step 7	Nobody
 Attack / Support ×N	1  per march	Your tile → adjacent enemy/neutral tile	Step 8	Everyone (ticker)
 Raid	free	Adjacent enemy garrisoned tile	Step 9	The victim, always
 Move ×N	free	Your tile ≤2 away via your land	Step 10	Nobody
 Spy	1 	Enemy tile ≤3 from you	Step 11	Victim only if caught (25%)
 Heist	1 	Empire with land ≤2 from you	Daybreak	Everyone if caught (30%); nobody if not
 Market trade	5  ⇌ 1 	—	Instant	Nobody
 Pact / Withdraw	free	Any empire	Instant	Everyone (ticker)
 Message	free	Any empire	Instant	Just the two of you

Seven tips from the war college

1. **Spend your orders before bed.** They expire at Daybreak. Queue night moves and a heist — the morning reveal is where legends are made.
2. **Never march everyone.** You choose how many attack — the rest stay home and defend. An empty wall invites a counterstrike.
3. **Watch the red zeros.** A border tile showing 0 is an open door.
4. **The center is rich and crowded.** Relic sites and bonus points — and everyone else wants them too.
5. **Pacts buy time, not safety.** Count the turns until expiry. So is your partner.
6. **An empty-looking empire isn't.** Wards hide armies, and quiet players are usually completing quests.
7. **Mind the ticker.** It tells you who's fighting, who's swearing oaths, and — vaguely — where the relics are moving.